

Ed Podojil

Data Professional

Ithaca, NY

• epodojil@gmail.com

• <https://www.linkedin.com/in/edpodojil/>

Data platform executive and product leader with 10+ years of experience bridging engineering, product, and enterprise analytics to deliver high-scale data systems. Proven record of driving business outcomes through modern data stack modernization, multimillion-dollar cloud financial governance, and transformative enterprise data strategy.

SKILLS

- **Strategic Leadership & Governance:** Data Platform Strategy, Enterprise Product Management (8+ yrs, 5+ in leadership), Cloud Financial Management (FinOps), Cross-Functional Program Scaling, Vendor Procurement & Roadmap Steering, C-Suite & Board-Level Communication
- **Data Architecture & Modern Data Stack:** Data Platform Engineering, Petabyte-Scale Analytics, ETL/ELT Architecture, Change Data Capture (CDC), Reverse ETL, dbt, Fivetran, Census, Segment (CDP)
- **Cloud, Data Warehousing & Databases:** Google Cloud Platform (BigQuery, Dataflow), Amazon Web Services (Redshift), MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Vercel, Inngest
- **Analytics, BI & Machine Learning:** Mode Analytics, Looker, Tableau, Advanced SQL, Python (pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels), Experimentation Design & A/B Testing Frameworks
- **Operational & Product Delivery:** Agile/Scrum Methodologies, Technical Product Roadmapping, Jira, Asana, Coda, Notion

WORK EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder, Chief Product Officer

October 2024 - Current

Modern Research

- Secured \$1.8M in pre-seed funding to pioneer workflow and data solutions across the higher education and institutional research administration ecosystem.
- Cultivated high-trust relationships with senior research leadership, sponsored program directors, and finance executives across major R1/R2 universities and non-profit research institutions.
- Architected and deployed tailored product solutions for sponsored grant accounting and effort certification, automating critical operational workflows to capture 20% in FTE capacity savings.
- Advised institutional research administrators and analytics teams on data engineering, BI best practices, and modern reporting architectures to elevate organizational data maturity.

Data Consultant

October 2024 - Current

Executive Director, Data Platform

November 2019 - October 2024

Director, Data Platform

November 2018 - November 2019

The New York Times, New York, NY

- Established and directed an 8-person data platform product organization, aligning cross-functional engineering, product, and executive stakeholders to drive enterprise value across experimentation, audience activation, machine learning, and centralized data warehousing.
- Governed a ~\$10M annual vendor and infrastructure portfolio, negotiating a multi-year \$5.4M commitment that yielded \$2.5M in annual cost optimizations while securing strategic influence over their product roadmap.
- Architected the enterprise audience and experimentation strategy in collaboration with executive leadership, driving measurable gains in subscriber conversion and deploying an industry-leading on-demand newsletter and push notification infrastructure.
- Directed the architectural roadmap and tooling evaluation—integrating dbt, Fivetran, Mode, and Census—to modernize data platform capabilities and dramatically accelerate delivery cadences across business units.
- Partnered with the SVP of Data Engineering to synthesize portfolio performance metrics, co-authoring strategic briefings and presentations for executive leadership and the Board of Directors.

Senior Manager, Product Analytics

June 2015 - November 2018

The New York Times, New York, NY

- Spearheaded the migration of the enterprise clickstream infrastructure from AWS to GCP, deploying a modern streaming architecture (Apache Beam / Dataflow) to ingest 15 TB/day. Established ETL pipelines and tiered archival strategies that reduced production storage by 80%, cut cloud expenditures by \$360K annually, and increased peak-traffic availability from 50% to 99.99%.
- Directed the organization-wide data warehouse migration from legacy Redshift and Hadoop systems to Google BigQuery, reducing query latency from 15+ minutes to sub-5-second execution and radically accelerating insight delivery for cross-functional stakeholders.
- Designed and scaled an internal query orchestration and pipeline governance platform (Flask/Redis) supporting 100+ active analysts. Standardized version control, dependency management, and workflow automation, successfully executing 90% of group-wide ETL processes across 5,000+ daily production queries.

Analytics Engineering Consultant

January 2015 - June 2015

Self-Employed

- Managed data engineers to develop new ETL solutions pulling data out of closed-systems, like Salesforce, to enable new analytics capabilities
- Improved transactional database operations by analyzing frequent high effort queries and building new indexes to match business operations.
- Developed LTV models to explain valuable customers and identify opportunities to senior leadership teams.

Data Science Instructor Fellow

May 2013 - 2017

General Assembly, New York, NY

- Taught Data Science in New York for multiple quarters to over 100 students receiving Data Science certification as one of the highest rated data science instructors. Spent 4-6 hours/week in the evening teaching students.
- Developed the Data Science curriculum for classes and workshops for use in 18 General Assembly locations, and retrofitted for an "immersive" full-time Data Science course.
- Observed classrooms and provided instructional feedback for Data Science instructors to improve the quality of education, raising NPS by double digits and improving student retention.

Data Scientist/Engineer

October 2013 - January 2015

Homejoy, San Francisco, CA

- Built and maintained data pipelines from data sources (Google Docs, Adwords, App Engine) to a data warehouse through partnering with engineering and marketing teams to identify
- Created and maintained SLAs for metric availability and data quality, while improving the metric management process using python, pandas, and SQL, where most data pipelines went from constantly timing out to completing within seconds. This enabled iterative product improvements and drove a data-informed culture.
- Built web applications using R, Shiny, and Python for metric digestion, and provided additional analytics and CRM views to data not available or operational in the primary engineering stack, which elevated customer service representative experience and improved the ability to do outreach with cleaners.
- Deployed machine learning models on EC2 using customer data to predict customer retention and CLV based on a variety of features, identifying high-value customer segments for targeting, which decreased marketing costs and improved customer LTV.

Software Engineer

July 2011 - September 2013

Animoto, New York, NY

- Developed onsite marketing performance capabilities with ab test implementation to improve click thru metrics
- Optimized web app interfaces using templates and async loading to improve load performance by 50%.

EDUCATION

University of California, Davis, Davis, CA
Master of Arts - English Education

University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT
Bachelor of Arts - Music (Percussion)

TALKS, WRITING, AWARDS

Guest Lecturer @ Ithaca College, Business Analytics, Fall 2026
Guest Lecturer @ Ithaca College, Practical AI and Data Analytics, Spring 2026
Guest Lecturer @ Ithaca College, Data-informed Media, Fall 2025
Fireside chat @ Futuredata Conference: Gaming, Media, Entertainment, 2021
Google Cloud Platform, The Evolution of Data Architecture at The New York Times, January 2021
Google Cloud Platform, Fueling Innovation in the New Normal, December 2020
Publisher's Award, New York Times: Improving Efficiency and Effectiveness, Q3 2020
Publisher's Award, New York Times: Grow Long Term Profitability with Privacy and Tracking, Q1 2019
Talk @ Metis Bootcamp, Turning Machine Learning into Products, 2017
Talk @ Metis Bootcamp, Working on teams as a Data Scientist, 2016
Publisher's Award, New York Times: Excellence in Technology, Innovation and Business Performance, Q3 2016
Panel Speaker @ Wasserman Center, NYU, Career Development for Quant PhDs, Winter 2015
Panel Speaker @ Wasserman Center, NYU, Career Development for Quant PhDs, Winter 2014
TNW (interview), How Data Scientists are Changing the Face of BI, November 2014
Talk @ NYC, When Smarts Aren't Enough: How Good Data Can Take You Further, October 2014

OTHER THINGS

Taught high school English and percussion for schools in CT and CA.
Current timpanist and board member for the local community orchestra in Ithaca, NY.
Active member of the Finger Lakes Run Club, with a personal goal to run all six marathon majors.